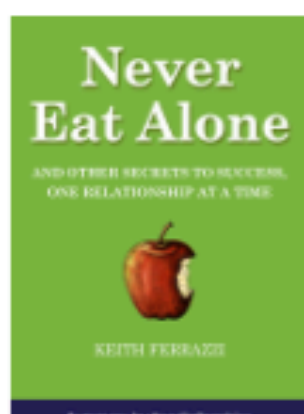




NEVER EAT ALONE

And Other Secrets to Success,
One Relationship at a Time

KEITH FERRAZZI



The Big "So What"

Relationships are a crucial part of both our professional and personal lives. They can open doors and bring success and fulfillment that you cannot achieve on your own. This book explains why you should make relationship-building a way of life, and how to build your personal network and brand.



Join the Club



To succeed, you can't rely on hard work and talent alone—you also need others' help and support. The rich get richer not just because of their financial resources, but because they have well-connected friends and associates who share valuable advice and open doors to the right people and opportunities. It's like being part of a privileged club.



It's never too late to join the club by cultivating the right relationships in the right way. By seeking the help and advice of successful people, building his relationship skills and network, Ferrazzi became the Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) at Deloitte & Touche Consulting, the youngest-ever CMO at Starwood Hotel & Resorts, then the CEO of Yaya Media, before starting his own company. In this book, he shares the insights accumulated from more than 2 decades of relationship-building. By applying these strategies and tips, you too can become a highly-accomplished connector.



Adopt the Right Mindset

Networking has a bad connotation because of people who build relationships just to exploit them. The key to successful networking is to add value to help *others* to succeed.

KEY QUOTES

*"Relationships are all there is. Everything in the universe only exists because it is in relationship to everything else. Nothing exists in isolation."
—Margaret Wheatley*

"You can't get there alone. In fact, you can't get very far at all."

"Business is a human enterprise, driven and determined by people."

"I learned that real networking was about finding ways to make other people more successful."



Don't keep score



Connecting is a two-way process of giving and receiving. Contribute generously to others *and* be willing to ask for others' help. Adopt the philosophy that everyone has the potential to help and be helped.

- When someone asks you for a small favor, just do it. Relationships are like muscles that grow stronger with regular use. The more people you help, the more people will help you and one another, to create a multiplier effect.
- In every interaction, ask "How can I help you?" instead of "How can you help me?" Don't keep score. Keep giving your time, money or expertise, and you'll eventually be rewarded.
- Be generous to everyone. Things move in cycles and you never know when you'll be the one who needs help. Someone who's insignificant today can very well become influential tomorrow.



Crystallize your mission and strategy



It's always easier to achieve something with a proper goal and strategy. Use 3 steps to make relationship-building a part of your strategy.

- Take time to figure what you truly want to do. Find your "Blue Flame" which lies the intersection of your mission, passion, and ability.
 - (i) Look *inward*. Brainstorm a list of your dreams and goals, followed by a list of things that bring you joy/pleasure. Then, connect the 2 lists to look for intersections.
 - (ii) Look *outward*: ask people who know you well what they admire most about you (your strengths) and what areas you need help in (your weaknesses).

KEY QUOTES

"Until you become as willing to ask for help as you are to give it...you are only working half the equation."

"The currency of real networking is not greed but generosity."

"Business cycles ebb and flow; your friends and trusted associates remain."

"Our achievements grow according to the size of our dreams and the degree to which we are in touch with our mission."

"Most people...accept what they 'should' be doing, rather than take the time to figure out what they want to be doing."

- Fill in the Networking Action Plan (NAP) to identify how to acquire the required skills, tools and resources. Put your goals down in writing. Keep them specific, believable, and challenging. Share your goals and put your plan somewhere visible.
 - (i) Define the *interim goals* (in 3 months, 1 year and 3 years) that'd bring you toward your mission.
 - (ii) List down the *people, places, and things* you'd need.
 - (iii) Assess the best *strategies* to acquire them.
- Create a personal "Board of Advisors" to help you stay on-track. At one point, Ferrazzi's goal was to be a CEO of a big corporation. After filling out his NAP, he sought inputs from his board. They pointed out that he lacked the qualifications to be the CEO of a large corporation, and he should go for a smaller company he could grow with. Ferrazzi redirected his focus and soon found an ideal role as the CEO of YaYa—a company that was pioneering online games as an advertising platform.



Build it before you need it



Relationships take time to build. It'll be too late to start building your network only when you need for it, e.g. when you lose your job or start a business. Start building your community today.

- Begin by connecting with and through the people you already know. For example, you can volunteer for a company project to learn new skills and meet new people, take on leadership positions outside work (e.g. in hobby or community groups), join an alumni club or attend a course where you can meet people with your dream job. Each new person you meet will bring even more connections and opportunities.
- Let's say you wish to start your own public relations (PR) firm in the future, but lack the necessary experience. Consider the industries you wish to specialize in, the future clients you'll need, and start making the connections now. Treat people as friends, not potential

KEY QUOTES

"An unwritten wish is just a dream. In writing, it's a commitment, a goal."

"A goal is a dream with a deadline."

"Building a relationship is necessarily incremental. You can only truly gain someone's trust and commitment little by little over time."

"The law of probability ensures that the more new people you know, the more opportunities will come your way and the more help you'll get at critical junctures in your career."

customers. Offer your services for free initially (say, at a nonprofit organization) so you can *gradually build your skills, credibility, and network*. By the time you start your business or make a career switch, you'd already have a ready pool of contacts who can provide vital references and world-of-mouth.



Have the courage to ask



It's much easier to stick to people you know than to approach people you don't know and/or ask for help. Be audacious enough to put yourself out there and ask for help or connections. People are often glad for the chance to contribute!



To overcome your fears:

- Realize that *it's normal* to feel anxious and uncomfortable.
- Weigh your fear of embarrassment/rejection against the *price of failing* in your goal/mission.
- Make a *commitment to improve*. For example, you can learn from role models who're great with people, improve your speaking skills (e.g. join the Toastmasters club, get a coach or join a course), practice your interpersonal skills in a club/community, or challenge yourself to meet 1 new person a week.



Don't be a networking jerk

Seek to build meaningful relationships. *Don't* swoop around shaking hands and collecting cards, engage in gossip, or blast out mass emails. *Do* have something meaningful to share, treat everyone with respect, honesty and transparency, and make genuine personal connections.



Develop the Required Skills

Be intentional about who you meet, how you meet them, and the impression you create.

KEY QUOTES

"Nothing in my life has created opportunity like a willingness to ask, whatever the situation."

"The choice isn't between success and failure; it's between choosing risk and striving for greatness, or risking nothing and being certain of mediocrity."

"Being liked can be the most potent, constructive force for getting business done."



Do your homework



Develop your name list. After you've defined your mission and interim goals, you must identify the names of specific people who can help you to get there.

- Start with people in your existing network, which is wider than you think. Consider the people connected to your relatives (and *their* friends), current and former colleagues, members of social/professional/religious groups, your children's friends' parents, former teachers/employers, existing suppliers etc.
- Keep expanding your aspiration list, i.e. the people you'd want to know but may not know yet. Organize your list using an app or software.



Always prepare before a meeting: research about their company, industry or job, their personal affiliations, and read up on articles written by or about them. Your goal is to get to know them as human beings: what they feel strongly about in/out of work, including their interests, hobbies, goals and challenges. Consolidate the points into a 1-page synopsis. Use the insights to connect with the person emotionally and start a real friendship.



Approaching new contacts



Don't make cold calls. Instead, warm up the cold leads in advance.

- Once you've researched the person's interests and associations, work backward to find people you know who're involved in similar causes/circles. Ask for an introduction or referral. If people are busy or slow to respond to your request, just put aside your ego and keep reaching out.
- Once you have the contact or referral, persist until you've set up a meeting. Use these 4 rules to warm up the call:
 - (i) Establish *credibility*: mention the familiar person/organization who referred you.

KEY QUOTES

"Find a way to become part of those things that are of most interest to them, and you will have found a way to become part of their life."

"Cold calls are for suckers. I don't call cold—ever."

"Selling is, reduced to its essence, solving another person's problems. And you can only do that when you know what those problems are."

- (ii) State your *value proposition*, i.e. how you can solve their problem. Give just enough info to be enticing.
- (iii) Convey both *urgency and convenience*: suggest follow-up details and state that you'll do what's needed to meet on their terms.
- (iv) Start big and offer a *compromise* to secure a follow-up.



Manage gatekeepers artfully. See them as your allies and associates, and treat them with respect and dignity. Be persistent but not aggressive, always express appreciation for their help and never offend them. Remember: gatekeepers have a job to do. It's your responsibility to show why their boss should hear from you, e.g. make it clear that you were referred by the boss's friend or associate.



Be visible



Fill your social and events calendar. Never eat alone.

- Find meaningful ways to multiply your time and network. For instance, instead of meeting 3 people separately, you can invite all 3 to dinner. This allows you to concurrently meet more people *and* connect others in your network. You can always add some 1-1 time before/after dinner for deeper interactions.
- Go for quality over quantity. It's much better to make a quality connection in a first-class flight cabin than to meet a bunch of desperate job-seekers at a networking event.



Share your passions. Focus on what you excel in or are passionate about—you'll be much more comfortable and compelling in those areas. If you love food, music and sports, then invite people to join you for meals, concerts and sporting events. Match people's interests to the events.



Follow up consistently

People won't remember you unless you rigorously follow-up with them. Always follow up within 12-24 hours from a meeting.

KEY QUOTES

"Always respect the gatekeeper's power. Treat them with the dignity they deserve."

"The more new connections you establish, the more opportunities you'll have to make even more new connections."

"Shared interests are the basic building blocks of any relationship."

"The follow-up is the hammer and nails of your networking tool kit."

- Express your pleasure and gratitude for the meeting, cite a common interest that you discussed, and thank them by name. You can also send relevant information on an issue they're facing, or send an additional handwritten thank-you note for a personal touch. Focus on what you can do for them (not vice versa).
- If any commitments were made, recap it in writing and arrange for a next meeting. For example, "I enjoyed our discussion yesterday. I've given some thought to [the issue discussed] and how [my company] can help to advance [your goal]. When I'm next in town, I'd love to arrange to meet for 5-10 minutes so I can share some of these finer details."
- Update the person who referred you and thank them for the help.



Become a conference commando



Don't attend conferences to listen to the speakers or sell your products. Your goal should be to meet like-minded people who can advance your mission. Get them to like you and set up follow-up discussions *after* the conference.



Get the most from conferences using these tips:

- Focus on the people, not the content. Only attend conferences if the value of the potential relationships outweigh the fees and time spent.
- Help or be the organizer. Volunteer your services so you can get inside information on the attendees and the best events for networking.
- Familiarize yourself with the event details and establish yourself as a go-to info source so people will want to connect with you.
- Be a speaker: This is one of the best ways to build visibility, credibility, and connect with other speakers/participants. Just get to know the organizer and have great content that's relevant to the conference guests.

KEY QUOTES

"Conferences are good for mainly one thing. They provide a forum to meet the kind of like-minded people who can help you fulfil your mission and goals."

"As an information resource, you're someone always worth knowing."

- Organize your own event(s) within the conference, e.g. host a private tour or dinner/drinks to informally discuss a topic.
- Identify the most prominent figures at the conference, attend their sessions and make an impression early (before their talk). They can open the doors to other key people at the conference.
- Know your targets. At each conference, Ferrazzi focuses on checking off a list of 3-4 key people whom he wants to meet. Strategically “bump” into them. Have a pre-prepared sound bite, i.e. 2-3 sentences that convey what you can do for them.
- Master the “Deep Bump”. Once you bump into your target, you have only 2 minutes to make a deep connection so they’ll like you and agree to reconnect again later.
- Make sure you follow up after the conference.



Expand your social circle



Connect with the super-connectors. Generally, we’re just 6 degrees away from anyone else in the world because someone will know someone who knows someone etc. Super-connectors are those who know thousands of people (from different worlds or social circles) well enough to give them a call. Once you’re familiar with a super connector, you’re just 2 degrees away from any person you wish to know. A disproportionate number of super-connectors can be found in these 7 professions: restaurateurs, headhunters, lobbyists, fundraisers, politicians, journalists, and PR specialists.



Another efficient way to grow your network is to link your circle with someone else’s.

- Identify the world you want to access, and exchange networks with a key figure in that world. For instance, to meet doctors for your new product, you can host dinners for a well-connected doctor and his contacts, while similarly linking him to relevant contacts in your network.

KEY QUOTES

“Don’t think of your next conference as a business-related retreat. Think of it as a well-coordinated campaign to further your mission.”

“In one word: Connect. In four better words: Connect with the connectors.”

“The underlying dynamic at work has to be mutual benefit. It should be a win-win for all involved.”

- This requires mutual contribution and trust between the 2 partners. Set clear expectations upfront, and ensure that your contacts also benefit from the connections. Never give anyone full access to all your contacts.



Master the art of small talk



The goal of small talk is to start a conversation, engage the other person and leave with them with a deep liking for you. The best way to stand out is simply to be yourself. Dare to be vulnerable and share from the heart. In so doing, you invite others to open up, allowing commonalities to surface and real bonds to be formed.

- Nonverbal cues are vital in creating positive first impressions. Give a warm smile, maintain eye contact, nod, lean in slightly, and add a light touch on the elbow if appropriate.
- Be prepared with conversational content on current affairs or a niche/specialty you're passionate about.
- Make them feel special. Be genuinely interested in what they say. Ask questions, listen fully, nod, laugh at their jokes, and always remember their name.
- Match or mirror the other person's Johari Window or how much you reveal of yourself.
- Exit gracefully. End with an invitation to meet again.



Convert Connections Into Compatriots



Create an emotional impact thru' health, wealth & children



When you help someone to achieve what they really want, you win their loyalty and create deep bonds that last the test of time.



Often, people's deepest desires come down to one of 3 things: making money, finding love, or changing the world.

KEY QUOTES

"Charm is simply a matter of being yourself. Your uniqueness is your power."

"Power, today, comes from sharing information, not with holding it."

"When you understand someone else's mission...that will help you create deep, long-lasting bonds."

- Self-actualization (the desire to maximize one's potential) is at the top of Maslow's hierarchy of human needs.
- But to get there, you must first meet your basic needs. When you help someone through a health crisis, improve their personal wealth, or show genuine interest in their children, you address their basic needs while empowering them to move up Maslow's hierarchy to seek higher aspirations, thus creating a big emotional impact. However, if you make empty promises and fail to deliver on these important issues, it'll also backfire.



Practice social arbitrage



The best way to gain power is to become indispensable to others by brokering contacts, information and goodwill. Social arbitrage is about linking people and opportunities from different worlds that wouldn't otherwise meet.

- You can introduce people from different circles who can mutually benefit, e.g. a friend who urgently needs to find a house and a reliable realtor who specializes in that area.
- You can also trade in knowledge, e.g. reading up on a topic, then share the insights with people who can benefit from them. Or, pass on the insights from 1 party to another.



Ping constantly



The only way to remember people (and vice versa) is to constantly stay in touch. "Pinging" is any form of fast, casual greeting.

- In new relationships, people must see/hear your name in ≥ 3 modes of communication (e.g. e-mail, phone call, face-to-face meeting) before they can recognize you.
- To cultivate a developing relationship, you must call or e-mail at least once a month.

KEY QUOTES

"It's a sort of ongoing puzzle, matching up the right people and the right opportunities."

"You have to feed the fire of your network or it will wither or die."

- To convert a contact into a friend, you need minimally 2 face-to-face meetings outside the office.
- To maintain a secondary relationship, you must ping minimally 2-3x per year.



You can ping people anytime, anywhere. Use personal events (e.g. birthdays and anniversaries) as opportunities to reach out. Develop a system for regular pinging:

- Segment your contacts based on your goals and mission (e.g. personal, customers, key associates, aspirational contacts).
- Number each contact based on the mode/frequency that you'd ping them.
- Create call lists by categories (e.g. reach out to people in a certain area or city during your travels).



Find and feed your anchor tenants



A shared meal in the comfort of your home is a great way to bring together people from different worlds and create new friendships.



Find "anchor tenants" or people outside your social circle who're interesting and can bring positive brand associations. Examples include journalists, artists, actors, or C-level executives.

- Once you've successfully invited an anchor tenant to your party, it's easier to attract others who wouldn't normally attend. Have a blend of energetic, interesting people you want to do business with, in addition to your friends and family.
- Your main goal is relationship-building, so keep your events fun and minimize business agendas.

KEY QUOTES

"When it comes to relationship maintenance, you have to be on your game 24/7, 365 days a year."

"Anyone who can add a little electricity to your dinner party is an anchor tenant."



Trade Up and Give Back



Stand out with interesting content



To stand out as a marketer or networker, you *must* have an interesting, unique point of view and specialized knowledge that others lack. To become a content expert in your field:

- Pick a niche that has real value for you and your company. Immerse yourself in cutting-edge ideas and info, and get to know people in that space (e.g. early adopters, knowledge brokers.) Get creative insights by asking lots of questions and connecting the dots between seemingly-separate things.
- Digest and distill the insights into a clear message about how these will impact people in your industry or domain.
- Share by teaching, writing and speaking about your expertise. Progressively master your brand, content and hooks (i.e. something that interests you and others).
- Your end-goal is to present your content as a compelling story that'd move and mobilize people.



Build and broadcast your personal brand



Your personal brand is what people think of when they hear your name. A strong brand builds your network by (i) providing a credible and unique identity, (ii) presenting a compelling message, and (iii) attracting people to you and your cause.



There are 3 steps to developing a strong personal brand:

- Define your personal branding message (PBM), which is the culmination of what we've discussed so far: Mission → Goals → Content → PBM. This should include the words you want people to use when they speak of you.
- Package your brand with a distinct style that stands out.

KEY QUOTES

*"Being known is just notoriety.
But being known for
something...That's respect."*

*"You have to believe in
something...for people to
believe in you."*

*"Perception drives reality and
that we are all, in some sense,
brands."*

*"The world is your stage. Your
message is your 'play.' The
character you portray is your
brand. Look the part; live the
part."*

- Broadcast your brand. Once you have great content, present it in a way that'd be picked up by others.



Create a PR strategy to broadcast your brand and create buzz.

- You can engage PR companies as facilitators, but always take charge of your own PR. Build personal relationships with the media *before* you need them: contact reporters who cover your industry, send them info and inside scoops, bring them for lunch etc.
- Help the journalists to do their jobs. Know the media landscape, each publication's focus and target audience, and tailor your pitch for their audience. Give them a great story and show appreciation for their work.
- Find creative ways to make your pitch sound original and fresh. Master your sound bites, i.e. explain in ≤10 seconds why they should write about you *now*. Associate yourself with a celebrity or big name to make your pitch more interesting.
- Start small with a local newspaper, magazine, a college paper or even a free industry digital newsletter. The more people write about you, the more other reporters will find you.



You can also write your own articles to boost your visibility and credibility. Figure out your content and hook, pitch your idea to an editor and persist/re-pitch until you get published.



Get close to power



To truly grow your network and influence, you must learn to reach out to important people.

- You can gain power through internal associations (e.g. being an assistant or gatekeeper to the decision-makers) or external associations (e.g. links with politicians and celebrities).

KEY QUOTES

"If you don't promote yourself, however graciously, no one else will."

"There are no new stories, it has been said, only old stories told in new ways."

- Famous and powerful people are also human beings. To gain their trust, you must be discreet, treat them as real people, be genuinely interested in them (not their fame), and help them to achieve their goals and dreams.



There're many places where you can meet powerful people or rising stars. Join a political fundraising campaign, become a conference speaker, support nonprofit organizations, or take up sports (especially golf).



You can also build your own club. Once you've figured out your Unique Selling Proposition (USP) for a cause, passion or expertise, use it as the basis to start your own club. Invite like-minded people to join you and let them invite others to grow the club.



As you get closer to powerful people and gain recognition, never get arrogant and entitled. This is a sure way to lose friends and offend people. Stay humble and never forget those who helped you in the past.



Continually find mentors and mentees



Learn from successful and inspiring people. An experienced mentor can make a profound impact on your career.

- The best mentor-mentee relationships are based on mutual benefits and emotional connections, e.g. the mentee offers hard work and loyalty in return for the mentor's time and advice. Be humble. Listen carefully to what your mentor has to share. Ask great questions and apply their advice. Consider your mentor's needs, be willing to contribute (e.g. help out in their company or community), and show your gratitude and passion to learn.



Deliberately reach down to help others who haven't "made it" yet.

KEY QUOTES

"Building a community of like-minded people around a common cause or interest is, and has always been, a very compelling proposition in its own right."

"Arrogance is a disease that can betray you into forgetting your real friends and why they're so important."

"The less you say, the more you'll likely hear."



Make relationship-building a way of life



The Internet has removed traditional boundaries and made everything more interdependent. There's no better time to find your blue-flame, connect with others and grow your network.



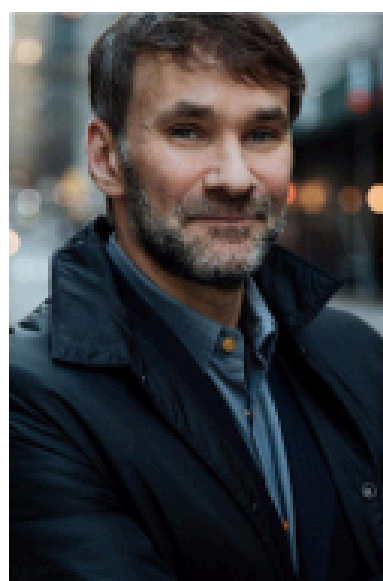
When you're surrounded by deep, meaningful connections that concurrently serve your work/life goals *and* benefit others, there's no need for "work-life balance". If you're joyful and enthusiastic about what you do each day, then you're already in balance.



Other Details in the Book to Look Out For

This is a practical guidebook for becoming a great connector. For each of the insights captured in this summary, the book also includes other useful tips, ranging from how to host a great party to lines you can use in your interactions. Ferrazzi also includes many examples from his personal experience, with short profile stories of notable relationship-builders such as Bill Clinton, Katharine Graham and Dale Carnegie. For more details, please visit www.keithferrazzi.com.

About the Author



Keith Ferrazzi is an American author and entrepreneur. He's the founder and CEO of research and consulting firm Ferrazzi Greenlight. After graduating from Yale University and Harvard Business School, Ferrazzi joined Deloitte as an entry level analyst and rose to become the chief marketing officer (CMO). At 32, he became Starwood Hotels' CMO—the youngest Fortune 500 CMO at that time. In 2000, he became the CEO of YaYa Media, which was later sold to American Vantage in 2003.

KEY QUOTES

"The best thing about a relationship-driven career is that it isn't a career at all. It's a way of living."

"Life is about work, work is about life, and both are about people."